Institutional Governance Maturity Assessment

Board & CEO Report — Illustrative Sample (Fictional Organisation)

Organisation	XYZ Foundation (fictional)	**Assessment Period**	FY 2025–26 (illustrative)
Prepared By	Head of Finance (15-Sep-2026)	**Approved By**	Board of Trustees (illustrative) (29-Sep-2026)

3.42

Overall Maturity Level:
Level 3 – Defined
Elevated Risk — Below Floor (4.0)
Peer Benchmark: 3.72 / 5.0

Pillar Scores

Pillar	Score	Maturity Level	Visual (0-5)
Board Governance & Strategic Oversight	3.65	Level 4 – Managed	■■■■■■■□□□
Risk, Resilience & Continuity	2.85	Level 3 – Defined	■■■■■■□□□□
Financial Stewardship & Sustainability	3.41	Level 3 – Defined	■■■■■■■□□□
Compliance, Ethics & Legal Protection	3.83	Level 4 – Managed	■■■■■■■■□□
Leadership, Talent & Succession	3.07	Level 3 – Defined	■■■■■■□□□□
Operational Excellence & Delivery	3.71	Level 4 – Managed	■■■■■■■□□□
Digital Governance & Data Protection	2.90	Level 3 – Defined	■■■■■■□□□□
Stakeholder Trust & Institutional Credibility	3.92	Level 4 – Managed	■■■■■■■■□□

Immediate Priorities (Next 30 Days)

No critical (Level 1) pillars identified. Focus on Reactive-level gaps below.

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30 / 60 / 90 Day Action Plan & Executive Narrative

0–30 Days: IMMEDIATE

No critical (Level 1) pillars identified. Focus on Reactive-level gaps below.

31–90 Days: SHORT-TERM

No high-risk (Level 2) pillars. Maintain progress and address Level 3 gaps.

3–12 Months: MEDIUM-TERM

Strengthen Level 3 pillars (currently Defined) to Level 4 (Managed). Key focus: documentation, monitoring, and Board oversight. Highest-weight pillar requiring attention: Risk, Resilience & Continuity. Target overall score at or above 4.0 (the floor) within 12 months, working toward 5.0 (ideal).

Executive Narrative

This Governance Assessment covers 60 questions across 8 pillars. Overall maturity score: 3.42/5.00 — Level 3 – Defined | Elevated Risk — Below Floor (4.0). Strongest: Stakeholder Trust & Institutional Credibility (3.92). Weakest: Risk, Resilience & Continuity (2.85). Review Scores_View col I for per-question gap actions and col L for the governance risk consequence of each gap. Implement the 30-60-90 day action plan above. 2 of 8 pillars are below Level 3 (Defined) and need Board attention. Priority owners should be assigned and progress tracked at each Board meeting.

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Pillar-Wise & Question-Wise Assessment

Per-question scores and recommended actions, grouped by pillar. For owner assignment, target dates, and status tracking, see the Assurance_Report tab.

P1: Board Governance & Strategic Oversight | Pillar Score: 3.65 | Level 4 – Managed

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q1	Board Skills & Competency	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q2	Board Independence	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q3	Board Composition & Diversity	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Board Composition & Diversity — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q4	Strategic Oversight	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Strategic Oversight — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q5	Board Information Quality	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Board Information Quality — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q6	Board Committee Effectiveness	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Board Committee Effectiveness — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q7	Board Evaluation	3.40	Attention	Action: Strengthen Board Evaluation — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 2 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q8	Governance Policy Framework	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Governance Policy Framework — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P2: Risk, Resilience & Continuity | Pillar Score: 2.85 | Level 3 – Defined

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q9	Enterprise Risk Management	1.80	Critical	Action: Strengthen Enterprise Risk Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 16 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q10	Risk Appetite & Tolerance	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Risk Appetite & Tolerance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q11	Donor Dependency Risk	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Donor Dependency Risk — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q12	Business Continuity Planning	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Business Continuity Planning — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 6 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q13	Crisis Management Readiness	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Crisis Management Readiness — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q14	Leadership Continuity	2.20	Critical	Action: Strengthen Leadership Continuity — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 6 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q15	Scenario Planning	2.20	Critical	Action: Strengthen Scenario Planning — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q16	Risk Reporting & Escalation	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Risk Reporting & Escalation — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P3: Financial Stewardship & Sustainability | Pillar Score: 3.41 | Level 3 – Defined

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q17	Financial Sustainability	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Financial Sustainability — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q18	Reserve Adequacy	1.80	Critical	Action: Strengthen Reserve Adequacy — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 8 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q19	Cash Flow Governance	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Cash Flow Governance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q20	Internal Financial Controls	4.20	Met	Action: Strengthen Internal Financial Controls — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 2 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q21	Segregation of Duties	3.40	Attention	Action: Strengthen Segregation of Duties — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 2 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

Q22	Treasury Management	4.20	Met	Action: Strengthen Treasury Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 1 gap (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q23	Budget Discipline	3.40	Attention	Action: Strengthen Budget Discipline — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q24	Funding Diversification	1.80	Critical	Action: Strengthen Funding Diversification — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q25	Financial Scenario Modelling	3.40	Attention	Action: Strengthen Financial Scenario Modelling — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 2 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q26	Financial Transparency	4.20	Met	Action: Strengthen Financial Transparency — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 1 gap (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P4: Compliance, Ethics & Legal Protection | Pillar Score: 3.83 | Level 4 – Managed

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q27	Regulatory Compliance Framework	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Regulatory Compliance Framework — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q28	Legal (including FCRA) Governance	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Legal (including FCRA) Governance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q29	Tax Exemption Compliance	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Tax Exemption Compliance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q30	Conflict of Interest Management	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Conflict of Interest Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q31	Whistleblower Framework	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q32	Safeguarding Framework	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Safeguarding Framework — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 6 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q33	Legal Risk Management	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Legal Risk Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q34	Compliance Monitoring	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.

P5: Leadership, Talent & Succession | Pillar Score: 3.07 | Level 3 – Defined

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q35	CEO Succession Planning	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen CEO Succession Planning — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q36	Key Person Dependency	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Key Person Dependency — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q37	Delegation of Authority	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Delegation of Authority — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 6 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q38	Leadership Pipeline	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Leadership Pipeline — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q39	Talent Retention	1.93	Critical	Action: Strengthen Talent Retention — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 10 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q40	Leadership Development	1.80	Critical	Action: Strengthen Leadership Development — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 9 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P6: Operational Excellence & Delivery | Pillar Score: 3.71 | Level 4 – Managed

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q41	SOP Documentation	2.87	Critical	Action: Strengthen SOP Documentation — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 8 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q42	Procurement Governance	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Procurement Governance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q43	Vendor Management	2.87	Critical	Action: Strengthen Vendor Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 7 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

Q44	Programme Oversight	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Programme Oversight — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q45	Quality Assurance	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q46	Continuous Improvement	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Continuous Improvement — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P7: Digital Governance & Data Protection | Pillar Score: 2.9 | Level 3 – Defined

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q47	DPDP / Data Privacy Compliance	1.87	Critical	Action: Strengthen DPDP / Data Privacy Compliance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 12 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q48	Cybersecurity Governance	1.80	Critical	Action: Strengthen Cybersecurity Governance — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 12 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q49	Data Governance Framework	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Data Governance Framework — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q50	Information Security Awareness	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Information Security Awareness — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q51	Technology Risk Management	1.93	Critical	Action: Strengthen Technology Risk Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 8 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q52	Reporting Integrity	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen Reporting Integrity — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

P8: Stakeholder Trust & Institutional Credibility | Pillar Score: 3.92 | Level 4 – Managed

Q#	Question	Score	Status	Recommended Action
Q53	Donor Confidence	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Donor Confidence — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 7 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q54	Transparency	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q55	Impact Reporting	3.00	Attention	Action: Strengthen Impact Reporting — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 5 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q56	Stakeholder Engagement	5.00	Met	Fully met — maintain and monitor.
Q57	Reputation Management	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Reputation Management — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q58	Institutional Credibility	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Institutional Credibility — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 3 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q59	Strategic Partnerships	3.80	Attention	Action: Strengthen Strategic Partnerships — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 2 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).
Q60	External Communication	3.93	Attention	Action: Strengthen External Communication — formalise policy, assign clear ownership, and close the 4 gaps (specific gaps listed in the assessment workbook).

Important note: this report was produced with the Institutional Governance Maturity Assessment Toolkit, a management self-assessment tool. It reflects only the responses entered, is not legal, regulatory or other professional advice, and does not certify compliance or governance standing.